Ivan Tucakov
and Tambura Rasa



PRESS KIT

Ivan Tucakov & Tambura Rasa

Tambura Rasa is a buoyant cultural cross-pollination that fuses contemporary grooves and traditional rhythms into one energetic musical brand of their own. The act weaves a tapestry of sound and dance from Balkans, Spain, Turkey, Middle East and beyond.

They have become BC's favorite caravan of vivacious globalistas, filling everything from intimate soft-seat theatre shows to large dance filled festivals in attempt to bring joy, vigor and dance to the world around them.

Join them as they merge the sounds of the East and the West, of the present and the past - a show of contemporary musical fusion and variety of cultural styles from all around the world.





Tambura Rasa core line up:

Ivan Tucakov - Guitar, Vocals
Johannes Kroller - Violin/Mandolin/Yehu
Langston Raymond - Trumpet, Percussion
Dino Dinicolo - Bass, Beat-Box



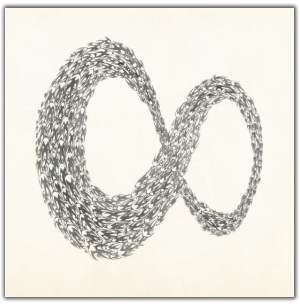
Ivan Tucakov was born in Belgrade, Serbia. He shared his childhood between southern Turkey and Serbia, where he was immersed within the cultural influences of both Eastern and Western music. During this time he developed an interest in guitar and studied under the Berkley School of Music curriculum. In 1998, Ivan moved to Vancouver and made the decision to pursue a career in computer science. He graduated with an honors degree in Computer Science and Physics at the University of British Columbia.

With a desire to maintain music in his life, Ivan formed the Tambura Rasa collective in 2004 with the aim of expanding the boundaries of world-fusion music. He studied flamenco guitar in Granada Spain, while his journey further took him in the direction of music composition, production and musical direction. Ivan has since released eight collections of original compositions, predominantly influenced by Indian classical to Turkish, Balkan and flamenco music. He has produced electronic mixes, some of which were released on the European Café del Mar lounge compilations. Tambura Rasa's albums "Adsum", "In Concert" and "Arribada" all got nominated for Best World Music Recording of the year at the West Canadian Music Awards (WCMA).

In 2012, Ivan started a classical world-fusion project called "Vino & Forte" with pianist Oriana White, and has since produced and released two studio albums together. Vino & Forte currently organizes collaborative concerts and regularly performs for special events and concert productions across the province. In 2013, Toronto based radio station Jazz FM interviewed Ivan for a special edition documentary series called "Identities". Ivan also authored two decade-long literary volumes about evolution of cultures called Cultura Rasa (2019) and Forces of Society (2023)

Recent Discography

"Infinite" (2021)



In 2021, Ivan Tucakov wrote and produced his eighth Tambura Rasa studio album entitled "Infinite ∞", releasing it on vinyl record for the very first time. This production explores ever newer musical territories, adding modern-classical, folk-americana, and even prog-rock into his growing "world music repertoire".

"Vicennium" (2004-2024) - Greatest Hits



Vicennium is a curated collection that spans twenty years of Ivan Tucakov's musical explorations, derived out of thousands of creative encounters with a diverse range of world class performers. Weaving a spectrum of styles, this edition encompasses and even transcends cultures across continents. Join us on this journey of 40 remastered tracks from 8 albums, featuring independently released singles, assorted into a digital box-set of 4 distinct musical worlds: expansion of boundaries, dance, return to origins and reflection.

Singles (2023-2026)

- **Focaccia Joe** (2023)
- **Eupoliteia** (2023)
- **Moon weeps Stars – Elfin Saddle Op.No.1** (2024)
- **Son de la Tierra** (2025)
- **Time to Say** (2025)
- **Moj Drug** (2026)

Past Discography



"Sunrise on a New World" (2004)

Features West African music styles, Middle Eastern, Afro-Cuban and Indian Classical fusion.The song Cinnabar was featured on the Cafe del Mar Compilation CD Vol. 13.



"Viaje" (2006)

"A cut above typical flamenco jazz. This has spark, skill and great production." - The Province Newspaper

"The skill level of the performance ensemble is quite high, so world guitar fans should almost consider this a must-have. Highly recommended." - Guitar Nine Records

Flamenco compases Bulerias and Alegrias, Indian Ghazal, plus Balkan, Tango and Chinese blends.



"Kamanala" (2008)

"More than just world music, this is positively global in its reach with flamenco and Middle-Eastern music fusing with Balkan, gypsy and Afro-Latin, all performed with great skill and verve"
- The Province Newspaper

"Close your eyes and take a journey across cultures with this fusion of gentle yet intricate flamenco-jazz guitar from the Spanish Mediterranean coast, Afro- Cuban percussion, and a flute solo by Pepe Danza." - Georgia Straight – song Gypsy Love - top 10

Flamenco Tango and Middle Eastern Fusion, Balkan Rhythms with Bulgarian musical art-forms; Afro-Latin mixed with Reggae; Indian Classical, R&B fusion.



"Tambura Rasa Beats" (2009)

A lounge electronica compilation of remixes of a collection of Tambura Rasa world fusion compositions from 2005-2009 (Includes Cafe del Mar's releases: Cinnabar Mix and Gypsy Love Mix). Nominated for the WCMA 2010 World Recording of the Year.



"Adsum" (2011)

Nominated for the Western Canadian Music Award 2011 World Recording of the Year.



CD "In Concert" (2012)

Featuring the full Tambura Rasa ensemble. Nominated for the WCMA 2013 World Recording of the Year.



"Arribada" (2014)

The album lifts off with an outlandish and captivating cover of a classic rock & roll tune, which is followed by an upbeat dance clave taking you straight to Cuba! The journey then continues on with a luscious fusion of classical strings, traditional Balkan brass, tamburicas, Turkish darbuka, Indian tabla, bansuri, Flamenco guitar and more.

Nominated for the WCMA 2015 World Recording of the Year.

"As the globe stresses and strains along artificially drawn borders, Ivan Tucakov and Tambura Rasa pick up the musical threads that bind us all and weave them into a tapestry of discovery and delight."
- Cal Koat - World Beats Radio Canada

Notable Past Tambura Rasa Performances

July 13, 2004
“Sunrise” CD Release Concert
Vancouver, BC

Mar 3, 2006
Opening Act for Strunz and Farah
Commodore Ballroom, Vancouver, BC

June 9, 2006
“Viaje” CD Release Concert
Vancouver, BC

Jun 27, 2006
International Jazz Festival, Vancouver, BC

June 24, 2007
Mountain-Beats Fest, Revelstoke, BC

June 17, 2007
Dragon Boat Fest Vancouver, BC

July 8, 2007
Music in the Park Festival
Port Coquitlam

Aug 25, 2007
Festival at the Forks, Grand Forks, BC

Jan 17, 2008
CBC Radio 2 Recorded Concert
Vancouver BC

June 13, 2008
Artspeak Festival, Canmore, AB

Jul 18-20, 2008 FOTR Fest
Yellowknife, NWT

Aug 2, 2008
Komasket Festival - Vernon, BC

Aug 8-10, 2008
Edge of the World - Queen Charlotte Islands

Aug 30, 2008 Sunshine Fest
Powell River, BC

Nov 7, 2008
Northwest Folk Life Festival, Seattle WA

May 28, 2009
Rotary Centre For The Arts, Kelowna, BC

May 29 and 30, Dec 11 and 12, 2009
Dream Café, Penticton, BC

Feb 24, 2010
Vancouver Olympics, Livecity Vancouver, BC

July 1, 2010
Ottawa Jazz Festival, Ottawa, QC

July 2, 2010
Yonge and Dundas Square, Toronto ON

July 9, 2010
SunFest London ON

Sept 10 2010
Vancouver International Film Festival

Oct 24 2010
WCMA Gala, Kelowna BC

11 May 2011
Juan de Fuca Festival, Port Angeles, WA

July 1 2011
Canada Day Festival, Port Coquitlam, BC

July 9 2011, July 12 2013 Harrison Festival, Harrison,BC

July 16 2011
Nakusp Music Festival, Nakusp, BC

June 10 2012
Vancouver International Bangra Festival, BC

July 21 2012
South Country Fair, Fort Macleod, AB

Aug 10 2012
Harmony Arts Festival, West Vancouver, BC

Apr 19 2013
Coast Inn of the North, Prince George, BC

July 12 2013
Harrison Festival of the Arts, Harrison, BC

June 15 2013
Gibsons Landing Jazz Festival, Gibsons, BC

June 21 2014
Dragon Boat Festival - Vancouver, BC

July 1 2015
Vancouver International Jazz Festival - Vancovuer, BC

July 17/18 2015
Vancouver Folk Festival - Vancouver, BC

July 24 2022
Surrey Fusion Festival - Burnaby, BC

June 16 2024
Gibsons Jazz Festival - Gibsons, BC

July 6 2024
Khatsalano Festival - Vancouver, BC

Aug 31 2024
Sunshine Festival - Powell River, BC

Sept 1 2024
Quadrapalooza Festival - Quadra Island, BC

July 20 2025
Surrey Fusion Festival - Burnaby, BC

Reviews

"It is impossible to box Tambura Rasa into a genre, with them dipping into Spanish, African, Latin and Gypsy styles. Tambura Rasa have definitively built a reputation for big festival and theatre shows using flamboyant flamenco and belly dancers to transport their audiences through time and across continents."
The Revelstoke Free Press - Steph Flemings

"Members of this Vancouver collective fuse world rhythms into one energetic musical brand all their own. Most genre-fusing artists struggle to come up with an original sound with substance, but Tambura Rasa has blended genres and diverse culture from nearly every continent."
Nanaimo Daily News

"A Spanish guitar and contemporary tones with traditional rhythms, it's music that inspires vigorous and joyful reactions"
The Prince George Citizen - Christine Skorepa

"With Spanish guitar, violin and an Afro Latin percussion, Tambura Rasa will provide you with a culture shock without even leaving town. Expect the unexpected with this crew, coming from very different musical backgrounds makes for a very different sound."
Golden Star - Faith Dusevic

"More than just world music, this is positively global in its reach with flamenco and Middle-Eastern music fusing with Balkan, gypsy and Afro-Latin, all performed with great skill and verve"
The Province - J.P.M. - on Kamanala CD

"Tambura Rasa will tantalize your senses with its high energy, electrifying, relentless and passionate musical brilliance."
The Source - by Melissa Anderson

"Ten tracks fusing rhythms and instruments from Balkan, Iberian, South American and South Asian traditions. A cut above typical flamenco jazz. This has spark, skill and great production."
The Province Newspaper - review by: Stuart Derdeyn - on Viaje CD

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www.tamburarasa.com

Bookings:

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